

STAGE TWELVE • LEADERSHIP

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Twelve • Leadership

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. Given how much this stage draws on other parts of the program, the close-out also helps participants see the throughline rather than experiencing thirty FIRSTS as a disconnected list.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today was about the foundation: understanding what leadership actually is, assessing your own style, taking real ownership, stepping into a role, leading a meeting, setting a goal, communicating vision, delegating, building accountability, and making a real decision."

"The common thread today was earning trust through action, not claiming it through title. Everything we do for the rest of this stage builds on that foundation."

"Before next time: think of one person you currently lead, mentor, or coach in any capacity, even informally."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"Today moved from setting direction to developing people directly: hard decisions, clear communication, motivation, mentoring, coaching, feedback, difficult conversations, conflict, performance review, and presenting with real conviction."

"Notice how much of today was about conversations people tend to avoid. Leadership often means having exactly the conversation that's easiest to postpone."

"Before next time: think of one person you need to influence without formal authority over them."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Twelve, complete. We've gone from the foundations of what leadership actually is, through developing the people directly around you, to leading across functions, influencing without authority, and staying steady under real pressure."

"Today you wrote your own leadership philosophy and a real development plan. Those aren't finished products — they're living documents worth revisiting as you actually lead more."

"Before we close: name one specific milestone from your development plan, out loud or in a shared doc."

"Stage Thirteen picks up with Teamwork & Collaboration — the other side of the coin from leadership, being a genuinely strong team member and collaborator."